foreword

Welcome to *Django in Action*! I'm sure you're excited to begin your Django journey. First, though, let me give you a little background on my friend, Christopher Trudeau, who has put a huge amount of effort into writing this book for you.

Christopher has a passion for communicating technical details, especially around Python and Django. Christopher has been on my podcast, *Talk Python to Me*, where his appearances have ranked in the top 10% of episodes, spanning almost 10 years of interviews. He frequently co-hosts the *Real Python* podcast. Christopher has also written and recorded many courses (much of them focusing on Django), and he has worked in such industries as cloud computing, gaming, travel, and finance, to name a few. In short, he doesn't just talk the talk—he has experience to back it up.

With this book, you hold the key to the fascinating world of Python web development. There are many types of applications you could choose to build: desktop GUI apps, mobile apps, embedded apps, and more. But web applications, the kind you build with Django, are special. They are immediately accessible to everyone, everywhere. There is no approval process, nor are there any gatekeepers or developer fees. You have an idea. You figure out how to build it with Python. You publish it to the web, and you're on your way.

So why Django? Django is one of the "big three" web frameworks in the Python space, which together represent the vast majority of adoptions. The people behind Django have spent years building their community.

Only Django, amongst the web frameworks, has the Django Software Foundation, a 501(c)(3) nonprofit foundation, to ensure the community remains strong and provides direction for the project. Only Django has outreach programs, such as Django Girls, a nonprofit foundation that organizes free Python and Django workshops for